

**BSc Business Management (Supply Chain)**

**BMP6001 Dissertation**

## **RESEARCH PORTFOLIO**

### **Assessment 1 – Research Proposal**

# **Navigating Geopolitical Fragmentation: How Vietnamese Manufacturing SMEs Are Adapting Their Supply Chain Strategies in Response to the China+1 Shift and US Tariff Volatility**

*Programme: BSc Business Management (Supply Chain)*

Module: BMP6001 Dissertation

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## **1. Introduction and Research Background**

The global supply chain has been dramatically changed in recent years. The idea of chasing the lowest possible costs and finding the best manufacturing operations for goods has become complicated by geopolitical issues and uncertainties (Christopher, 2016). The trade war between the United States and China, which began in 2018, has forced many manufacturing companies to reconsider their dependence on Chinese manufacturing.

Vietnam has become one of the top destinations for the concept of moving operations to a “China + 1” location. Companies like Apple, Google, Boeing, and others have opened second manufacturing facilities in Vietnam alongside their existing facilities in China. Vietnam’s low labor costs, growing young population, free-trade agreements, and location in Asia make the country very attractive to manufacturing companies. Vietnam received \$25.58 billion in foreign manufacturing investments in 2024, and the United States became Vietnam’s largest export market to the country at \$119.6 billion (Market Research Vietnam, 2025; Source of Asia, 2026).

While the data regarding Vietnam’s economic growth and the development of its manufacturing industry is huge and often celebrated, very little is said about the experience of its smaller and medium-sized manufacturing companies. These smaller companies produce the bulk of Vietnam’s manufactured goods, but do not have the same resources as the country’s larger manufacturers. They experience the same issues as the other manufacturers in the nation, but with fewer resources to combat the issues that exist within the supply chain and the geopolitical world as a whole. Therefore, an understanding of how these smaller Vietnamese companies are faring in the current geopolitical chaos is of importance to comprehend.

## **2. Problem Statement**

The China+1 shift and the volatility of US tariffs in 2025–2026 are making it extremely difficult for Vietnamese manufacturing SMEs to systematically restructure their supply chains. Despite Vietnam's overall success as a relocation hub, many SMEs lack the organizational, technological, and financial resources needed for successful adaptation. Operational performance, competitiveness, and long-term viability have all suffered as a result. The main problem is that SMEs in emerging markets lack context-specific resilience frameworks. The majority of the literature currently in publication represents big Western companies, so its recommendations are out of step with Vietnamese realities, which are marked by the lack of resources, unofficial networks, and quick institutional change (Phan et al., 2023). By conducting qualitative primary research with SME owners and managers in Ho Chi Minh City, this study fills the gap and provides useful insights and a unique framework specifically designed for geopolitically dispersed emerging markets.

Another factor that has contributed to this problem is the lack of frameworks regarding supply chain resilience that are developed for small and medium-sized manufacturers in emerging markets. Perhaps a study that investigated the steps that small manufacturing companies in Vietnam are taking to improve their supply chains would be beneficial to address this issue (*Omeihe and Harrison, 2024*).

### **3. Research Aim**

This research aims to critically look into how small and medium-sized manufacturing enterprises in Vietnam are adapting their supply chain strategies in response to the geopolitical fragmentation and US tariff volatility of 2025/2026, and to develop an original conceptual framework that can help explain SME supply chain resilience in emerging market contexts.

### **4. Research Objectives**

1. Review the existing literature on supply chain resilience, dynamic capabilities, and institutional theory in the supply chains of small and medium-sized manufacturing enterprises in emerging markets.
2. Investigate what supply chain strategies Vietnamese SMEs are employing in response to the China+1 and US tariff strategy of 2025 and 2026.
3. Evaluate the barriers and enablers of SMEs in Vietnam to adapt their supply chain strategies to the current geopolitical environment.
4. Develop an original conceptual framework to explain the supply chain resilience of Vietnamese SMEs in the face of a geopolitically volatile and emerging market environment.

### **5. Research Questions**

1. What impact has the China+1 and US tariff strategy of 2025 and 2026 had on the supply chain operations of Vietnamese manufacturing SMEs?
2. What supply chain adaptation strategies are Vietnamese manufacturing SMEs employing, and from what effectiveness tests have been performed upon those strategies?
3. What obstacles prevent Vietnamese manufacturing SMEs from restructuring their supply chains according to the geopolitical environment of 2025 and 2026?
4. What factors enable some Vietnamese manufacturing SMEs to adapt to the geopolitical environment of 2025 and 2026 better than others?
5. How does Vietnam's institutional framework impact the supply chain adaptation strategies of Vietnamese SMEs?

### **6. Research Rationale**

The motivation behind this research topic is the need to investigate an issue that is currently occurring yet underrepresented in research. Vietnam's manufacturing SMEs are experiencing the impact of the unstable trade environment. According to Supply Chain Dive (2026), such geopolitical uncertainty is likely to continue into 2026, making it increasingly difficult for manufacturing SMEs in Vietnam to plan their supply chains. For these SMEs, those that can adapt to the geopolitical environment stand to gain benefit from the reshoring of manufacturing investments from the United States and China, while those that cannot adapt stand to lose their foothold in global supply chains. Furthermore, the geopolitical tensions in the South China Sea add to the challenges facing these Vietnamese manufacturing SMEs. While the multinational manufacturing giants in the region are able to weather these

geopolitical storms due to their financial might, the same is not true for Vietnamese SMEs.

In the academic sphere, there is also a lack of research on the topic of SME supply chain adaptation. The existing theories on supply chain resilience, such as the dynamic capabilities of Christopher and Peck (2004) or Ponomarov and Holcomb (2009), are based on the experiences of the supply chains of large manufacturing companies in Western nations. None of these theories can be directly applied to the supply chains of Vietnamese SMEs with fewer than 300 employees. Ivanov and Dolgui (2020) have published research on the viability of supply chains, which is a theory that better relates to the experiences of Vietnamese SMEs. Yet there is still a lack of research on the supply chains of SMEs in emerging markets like Vietnam - a reality that is only beginning to be recognized in recent years (LeMay, 2026; Phan et al., 2023). Hence, there is a necessity for research into this topic in the Vietnamese manufacturing SMEs to contribute to an existing research gap.

## **7. Justification of Choice**

There are several reasons for the choice of this specific topic for discussion. Most notably, I am based in Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam - the location of the manufacturing and logistics hub within the nation. Thus, I have an advantage in being able to directly interview the managers of these SMEs, instead of interviewing managers from locations away from these manufacturing hubs, or from other sources completely. Furthermore, my general knowledge of the region and its economy provides a further advantage in being able to fully understand the responses from those interviewed.

Also, the topic relates to the chosen supply chain management pathway in the degree programme. For instance, the programme has covered topics related to methods of conducting research, such as those by authors Saunders, Lewis and Thornhill (2019) and Bryman and Bell (2022). The geopolitical shifts that are occurring within the manufacturing sector of the world today have the potential to directly impact the supply chains in which supply chain management professionals work.

Finally, the topic is felt to be timely and unique. Vietnam's manufacturing industry has grown at a rapid rate over the past decade, yet there is little research that has been published on the country or its SMEs in relation to the current supply chain challenges within the nation. Thus, this dissertation fulfills one of the aims for Level HE6 dissertation programmes to contribute to the existing literature on the topic being discussed.

## **8. Review of Literature**

The aim of these theoretical frameworks and investigations into the research problems, are carefully considered in this part of the thesis. There is a review of relevant literature in three main areas: institutional theory, dynamic capacities theory, and supply chain resilience. Furthermore, a conceptual framework is created that includes each of these theories, plus a description of the research need that this study focus to fulfill. Table 1 below provides an overview of the literature that was

reviewed as part of this investigation.

| Author & Year                           | Type        | Context                 | Design    | Method            | Key Findings & Relevance                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------|-------------------------|-----------|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Ponomarov &amp; Holcomb (2009)</b>   | Conceptual  | Global/<br>theoretical  | Inductive | Lit review        | Defines the concept of supply chain resilience                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Christopher &amp; Peck (2004)</b>    | Conceptual  | Large Western firms     | Deductive | Lit review        | Introduces the concept of supply chain resilience as consisting of four properties. Used influential study but limited to large companies; addressed in this study.                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Teece, Pisano &amp; Shuen (1997)</b> | Theoretical | Large US<br>corps       | Deductive | Conceptual        | Introduces the concept of dynamic capabilities - firms must be able to sense, seize and reconfigure resources to take advantage of opportunities in their environment                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Ambulkar et al. (2015)</b>           | Empirical   | 209 US<br>manufacturers | Deductive | Survey/SEM        | Findings indicate that two components of supply chain resilience are more important than others: orientation towards potential disruptions in supply chains, and the ability to reconfigure the resources within those supply chains. However, the findings are not directly applicable to Vietnamese SMEs |
| <b>Ivanov &amp; Dolgui (2020)</b>       | Theoretical | Global networks         | Inductive | Conceptual        | Introduces the concept of "viability" of supply chains - the ability of supply chains to survive long periods of sustained disruption, such as increasing tariffs                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>DiMaggio &amp; Powell (1983)</b>     | Theoretical | Organisations broadly   | Deductive | Conceptual        | Introduces the concept of institutional isomorphism - the idea that organisations tend to behave in similar ways to others in their organisation, sector, country, etc. Utilised to discuss Vietnam government policy                                                                                      |
| <b>Phan et al. (2023)</b>               | Empirical   | Vietnamese SMEs         | Mixed     | Fuzzy VIKOR       | Presents findings of the main barriers to implementing SCR within Vietnamese SMEs                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>LeMay (2026)</b>                     | Empirical   | SMEs &<br>tariffs       | Deductive | Industry analysis | Investigates supply chains in small and medium-sized manufacturers exposed to high levels of tariff uncertainty; identifies their                                                                                                                                                                          |

|                                       |           |                     |           |               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------|-----------|---------------------|-----------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                       |           |                     |           |               | vulnerabilities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Eisenhardt &amp; Martin (2000)</b> | Empirical | Large & small firms | Deductive | Case analysis | Findings indicate that large and small companies have different dynamic capabilities. SMEs are less structured in their supply chains so they must often improvise to address supply chain issues. This finding was used as the basis for focusing on SMEs in this study. |

*Table 1: Summary Table of Literature Reviewed (adapted from Collis and Hussey, 2021)*

## 8.1 Supply Chain Resilience

Supply chain resilience is generally understood to be the ability of a supply chain to survive disturbances and come back to its expected level of operations (Ponomarov and Holcomb, 2009). This concept has become a standard in the field. Christopher and Peck (2004) found four characteristics that are essential for supply chains to be resilient: re-engineering their structures, their partners within the supply chain, their ability to adapt, and establishing a culture of risk management within the supply chain.

However, it is crucial to note that both of these frameworks were developed in the context of large and rich resource supply chain organizations. Thus, one limitation of these studies is in their consideration of application to SMEs within a country like Vietnam. For instance, while Ivanov and Dolgui (2020) considered the concept of “viability” (the ability of a supply chain to survive major disruptions over long periods of time) which is arguably more relevant to the current situation in Vietnamese supply chains (due to US tariffs and geopolitical tensions), Phan et al. (2023) discovered that Vietnamese SMEs do indeed have barriers to implementing the adaptations that would increase their viability (financial, technological, and relational resources). Nevertheless, neither of these more recent analyses specifically considers the constraints that SMEs face within an emerging market economy like Vietnam’s.

## 8.2 Dynamic Capabilities Theory

Teece, Pisano, and Shuen (1997) have published a paper that helps to explain the difference in the ability of some supply chains to adapt to changes in the environment relative to others. The authors assert that a company’s resources do not necessarily create its competitive advantage, but rather, that advantage emerges from a company’s ability to sense changes in different situations, take advantage of those opportunities, and adapt its internal operations to take advantage of those opportunities. In the case of Vietnamese SMEs, this framework can help to explain the difference in the success of some SMEs in re-engineering their supply chain compared to others that have not experienced the same successes.

Ambulkar, Blackhurst, and Grawe (2015) discovered that a company’s orientation towards potential supply chain disruptions and the reengineering of its operations are the two strongest predictors of a company’s ability to resist supply chain disruption. However, this study employed a sample that was limited to large manufacturers in

the US. Eisenhardt and Martin (2000) investigated the same topic but focused on small firms and found that small firms' dynamic capabilities are not the same as those of large firms. For instance, large firms often have processes to adapt to changes in the environment, but small firms rely on the individuals (often the owner) to adapt to those changes. This distinction between small and large firms' adaptations to change in their supply chains is often ignored in the context of the supply chain resilience of Vietnamese SME.

### **8.3 Institutional Theory**

DiMaggio and Powell's (1983) argument is that organisations are shaped not just by the competition within their markets but by the institutions in which they exist and operate. These institutions contain regulations, cultures, and the tendency of organisations within a particular industry to adopt the practices and strategies of their similar organisations. Vietnam's institutional environment has been changing rapidly in recent times. The country's government has introduced a variety of industrial policies, including the National Digital Transformation Program (significant provincial restructuring reforms in 2025) and new trade agreements with the United States. These changes have the potential to impact the strategies of manufacturing SMEs within the country (Source of Asia, 2026).

What is surprising about the majority of the supply chain resilience literature is the lack of attention paid to the impact of the institutional environment on manufacturing SMEs within Vietnam. Most of the existing literature considers the impact of variables within the manufacturing SMEs rather than the external environment. Such a consideration of the external environment is likely to reflect the experiences of SME manufacturers within Vietnam. Therefore, incorporating a consideration of the external environment as it relates to Vietnam and its institutions into the supply chain resilience literature is another contribution that this study can make to the existing literature.

### **8.4 Conceptual Framework**

Based on the theories discussed in this paper, an original framework for the study of the impact of geopolitical forces on supply chains of Vietnamese manufacturing SMEs can be proposed. The framework is represented in Appendix A.

The conceptual framework proposes that the dynamic capabilities of these SMEs will have a significant effect on their ability to succeed in adapting to the geopolitical environment in which they exist. The framework proposes three main propositions regarding these variables.

Proposition 1 states that higher levels of dynamic capabilities within Vietnamese manufacturing SMEs will have a positive impact upon their ability to succeed in adapting to the geopolitical challenges that they encounter.

Proposition 2 states that the geopolitical environment will have an impact on the dynamic capabilities of SMEs, specifically in the variables regarding the impact of government policies and trade agreements.

Proposition 3 proposes that there is an interaction between the dynamic capabilities



of the SMEs and the geopolitical environment. The interaction will result in Vietnamese manufacturing SMEs achieving either a positive outcome in terms of their operational and competitive advantages, or an adverse outcome if either one or both of these variables are lacking.

## 8.5 Research / Knowledge Gap

Research Gap: There are no studies that investigate the ability of manufacturing SMEs in Vietnam to adapt to the geopolitical dynamics of China moving to 2025, the United States moving into 2026 to 1+ countries, and the potential for tariffs on Vietnamese goods. While others have noted the lack of such studies on the topic (LeMay, 2026; Phan et al., 2023), no studies have examined this specific population within Vietnam. Thus, the research that will be performed in this study will help to fill this knowledge gap.

## 9. Research Methodology

### 9.1 Research Methods and Techniques

The methodology that will be used for this study is based upon the framework by Saunders, Lewis and Thornhill (2019), as represented in Figure 1 below. This framework enables the explanation of the relationship between the different components of the study and the justification for the choices of each of the stages of the study.

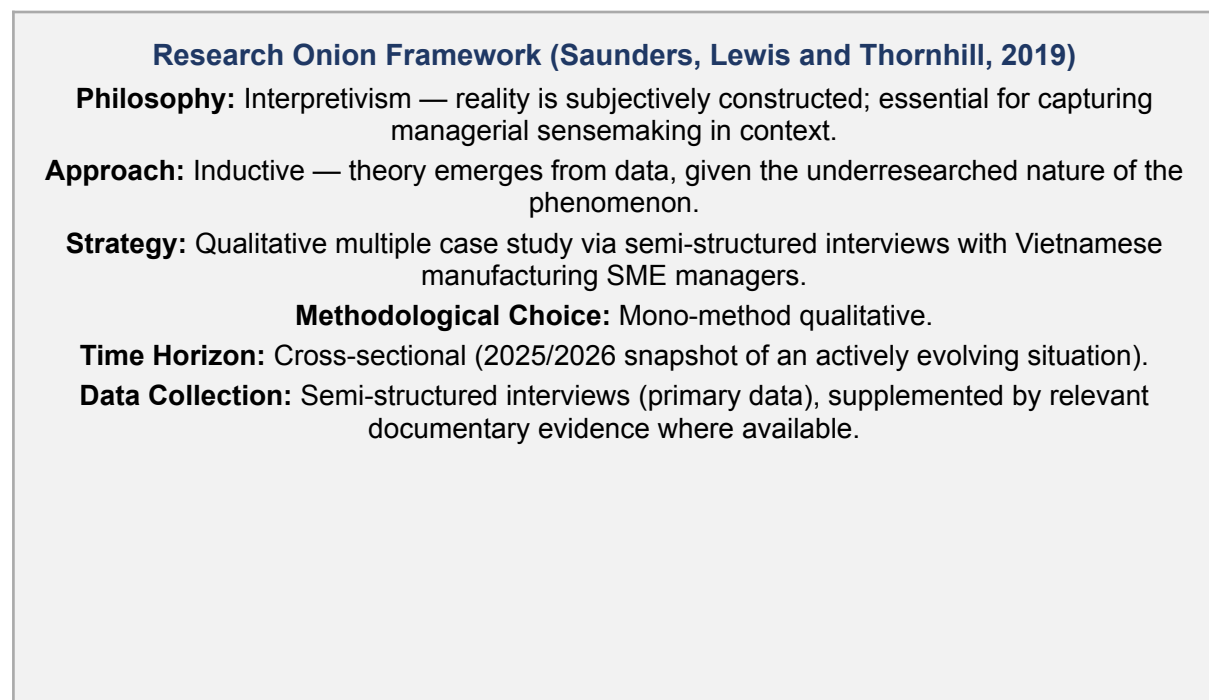


Figure 1: Research Onion Framework applied to this study (adapted from Saunders, Lewis and Thornhill, 2019)

The interpretivist philosophy assumes that the social world or social reality - the concept of strategy in the context of supply chains - cannot be objectively measured; it exists in the minds of individuals (Saunders, Lewis and Thornhill, 2019). This

stance in the research methodology discussion is appropriate due to the research questions posed. The research questions require understanding individual responses to geopolitical risks rather than measuring those responses. A positivist philosophy would suggest that the current geopolitical pressures in the supply chain can be measured and assessed, losing the essential contextual data for this study.

An inductive approach will be used as there has been no previous study of the experiences of the SME manufacturing industry in Vietnam under the current geopolitical situation. At this stage, it would be premature to pose a hypothesis to be tested. The insights that will be developed from the individuals interviewed will form the theory for this research project (Gray, 2020). A thematic analysis approach will be used to analyse the interview responses. This analysis follows the six-phase process of Braun and Clarke (2006). The deductive and inductive coding techniques will inform the research analysis according to the G-SCR Framework and findings from the interviewed participants.

## 9.2 Sampling and Techniques

The sampling technique that will be used will be purposive sampling. The participants that will be interviewed will be between 10 and 14 in number and will be the owners or senior managers of SMEs (fewer than 300 employees) in the electronics, textile, automotive, and consumer goods industries located in Vietnam's major cities. This number of participants was chosen as the ideal size for providing sufficient data while remaining feasible within the available timeframe (Bell, Waters and Johnson, 2024). The researcher's location in Vietnam will allow for the conducting of face-to-face interviews with the participants, an approach that promises richer data than remote interviews.

## 10. Project Plan

The Gantt chart depicted in Figure 2 represents all the activities that will take place throughout the research project from receiving the ethics approval until the completion of the Reflective Viva in August 2026.

| Activities                               | Apr  | May  | Jun  | Jul  | Aug  |
|------------------------------------------|------|------|------|------|------|
|                                          | 2026 | 2026 | 2026 | 2026 | 2026 |
| Ethics approval & supervisor sign-off    |      |      |      |      |      |
| Participant recruitment & scheduling     |      |      |      |      |      |
| Literature review refinement (Chapter 2) |      |      |      |      |      |
| Research Methodology (Chapter 3)         |      |      |      |      |      |

|                                         |  |  |  |  |  |
|-----------------------------------------|--|--|--|--|--|
| Primary data collection (interviews)    |  |  |  |  |  |
| Thematic analysis & coding              |  |  |  |  |  |
| Findings & Analysis (Chapter 4)         |  |  |  |  |  |
| Conclusions & Recommendations (Chs 5–6) |  |  |  |  |  |
| Full dissertation draft & review        |  |  |  |  |  |
| Final submission — 28 July 2026         |  |  |  |  |  |
| Reflective Viva — 4 August 2026         |  |  |  |  |  |

Figure 2: Project Gantt Chart — Research Activities and Timeline (April–August 2026)

**Key:** ■ Data/Writing ■ Ethics/Fieldwork ■ Analysis ■ Submission ■ Viva

## 11. Identifying Ethical Issues

The following is a discussion of the ethical issues related to the research study of the Vietnamese business environment. The University of Greater Manchester Research Ethics Checklist Form RE1 has been completed and will be submitted for approval by the supervisor. The information and consent forms for the participants have been prepared according to the templates provided by the university. Each participant will be made aware of the research study and that their participation is voluntary. Data related to commercially sensitive or confidential information will not be requested of the participants. The information that will be obtained from the participants will be used to create a research study with a focus on their experiences. Anonymity will be provided to the participants by using pseudonyms for those in the study, and the audio files will be stored and deleted after three years. The researcher is familiar with the business environment of Vietnam and will account for this in the research study through a journal and by discussing the study in the methodology chapter of the dissertation.

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## **Appendix A: G-SCR Conceptual Framework Diagram**

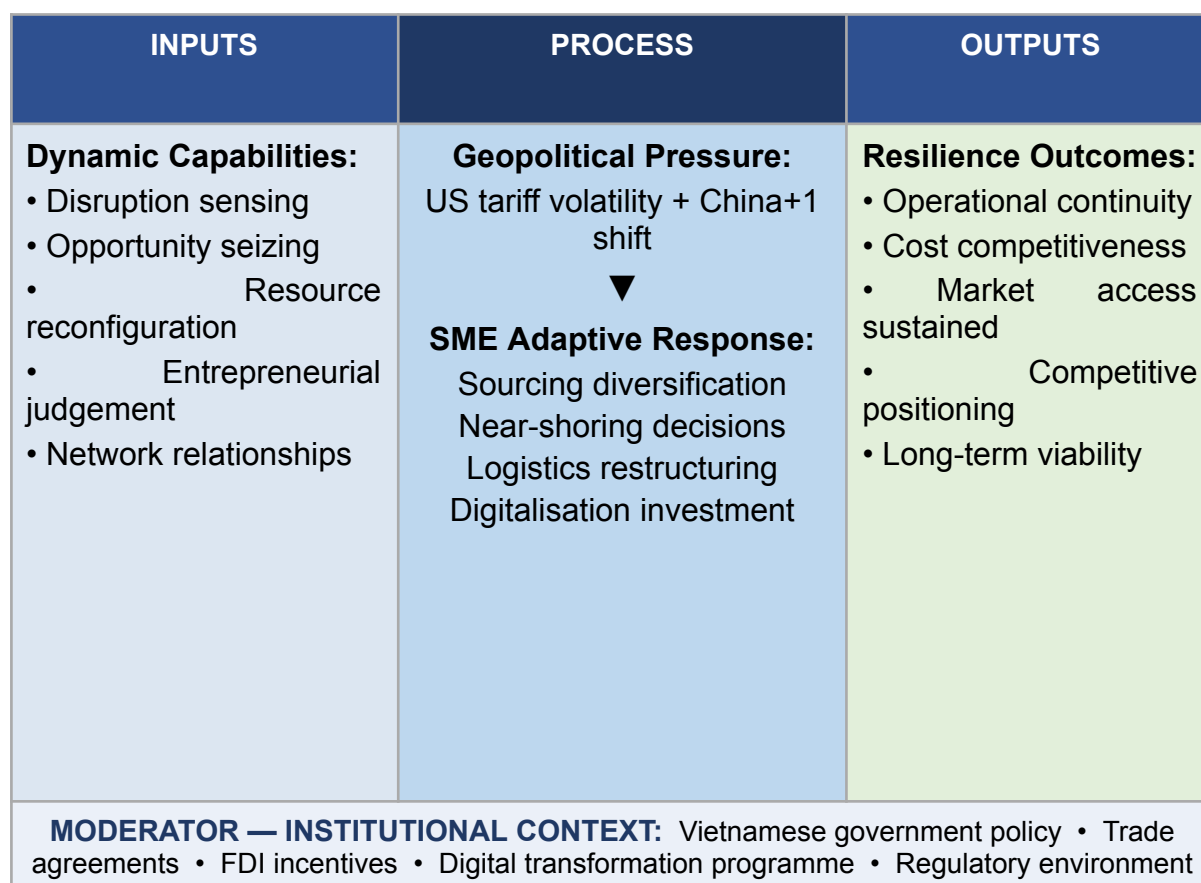


Figure D1: The G-SCR Framework (Author, 2026). Synthesised from Teece et al. (1997), Ponomarev & Holcomb (2009) and DiMaggio & Powell (1983).

### **Declaration:**

In completing this assessment, I declare that I did not use any Generative AI tools to generate written content in this submission. Grammarly was used in the final editing stage solely to identify and correct grammatical errors, punctuation and spelling. All ideas, arguments, critical analysis and written content in this portfolio are entirely my own original work, produced independently without AI content generation.

**RESEARCH ETHICS CHECKLIST**
**Form RE1**

This checklist should be completed for every research project which involves human participants. It is used to identify whether a full application for ethics approval needs to be submitted.

**Before completing this form, please refer to the University Code of Practice on Ethical Standards for Research Involving Human Participants.** The principal investigator and, where the principal investigator is a student, the supervisor, is responsible for exercising appropriate professional judgment in this review.

***This checklist must be completed before potential participants are approached to take part in any research.***

**Section I: Applicant Details**


|                                     |                            |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. Name of Researcher (applicant):  | Ly Gia Han                 |
| 2. Status (please click to select): | Undergraduate Student      |
| 3. Email Address:                   | lysshaan2005@gmail.com     |
| 4a. Contact Address:                |                            |
| 4b. Telephone Number:               | 35 street 25 Binh Phu ward |

**Section II: Project Details**

|                   |                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5. Project Title: | Navigating Geopolitical Fragmentation: How Vietnamese Manufacturing SMEs Are Adapting Their Supply Chain Strategies in Response to the China+1 Shift and US Tariff Volatility |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

**Section III: For Students Only:**

|                                                                                 |                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6. Course title and module name and number where appropriate<br><br>Department: | BSc Business Management (Supply Chain) — BMP6001 Dissertation<br><br> |
| 7. Supervisor's or module leader's name:                                        | Prof. Christian Harrison                                              |
| 8. Email address:                                                               | C.Harrison2@greatermanchester.ac.uk                                   |
| 9. Telephone extension::                                                        |                                                                       |

**Declaration by Researcher (Please tick the appropriate boxes)**

|                                     |                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | I have read the University's Code of Practice                                                |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | The topic merits further research                                                            |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | I have the skills to carry out the research                                                  |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | The participant information sheet, if needed, is appropriate                                 |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | The procedures for recruitment and obtaining informed consent, if needed, are appropriate    |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | The research is exempt from further ethics review according to current University guidelines |



#### Section IV: Research Checklist

Please answer each question by ticking the appropriate box:

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | YES                      | NO                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1. Will the study involve participants who are particularly vulnerable or who may be unable to give informed consent (e.g. children, people with learning disabilities, emotional difficulties, problems with understanding and/or communication, your own students)? | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 2. Will the study require the co-operation of a gatekeeper for initial access to the groups or individuals to be recruited (e.g. students at school, members of self-help group, residents of nursing home)?                                                          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 3. Will deception be necessary, i.e. will participants take part without knowing the true purpose of the study or without their knowledge/consent at the time (e.g. covert observation of people in non-public places)?                                               | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 4. Will the study involve discussion of topics which the participants may find sensitive (e.g. sexual activity, own drug use)?                                                                                                                                        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 5. Will drugs, placebos or other substances (e.g. food substances, alcohol, nicotine, vitamins) be administered to or ingested by participants or will the study involve invasive, intrusive or potentially harmful procedures of any kind?                           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 6. Will blood or tissues samples be obtained from participants?                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 7. Will pain or more than mild discomfort be likely to result from the study?                                                                                                                                                                                         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 8. Could the study induce psychological stress or anxiety or cause harm or negative consequences beyond the risks encountered in normal life?                                                                                                                         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 9. Will the study involve prolonged or repetitive testing?                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 10. Will financial inducements (other than reasonable expenses and compensation for time) be offered to participants?                                                                                                                                                 | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 11. Will participants' right to withdraw from the study at any time be withheld or not made explicit?                                                                                                                                                                 | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 12. Will participants' anonymity be compromised or their right to anonymity be withheld or information they give be identifiable as theirs?                                                                                                                           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 13. Might permission for the study need to be sought from the researcher's or from participants' employer?                                                                                                                                                            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 14. Will the study involve recruitment of patients or staff through the NHS?                                                                                                                                                                                          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |

If ALL items in the Declaration are ticked AND if you have answered NO to ALL questions in Section IV, send the completed and signed Form RE1 to your Departmental Research Ethics Officer for information. You may proceed with the research but should follow any subsequent guidance or requests from the Departmental Research Ethics Officer or your supervisor/module leader where appropriate. Undergraduate and taught postgraduate students should retain a copy of this form and submit it with their research report or dissertation (bound in at the beginning). MPhil/PhD students should submit a copy to the Board of Studies for Research Degrees with their application for Registration (R1). **Work which is submitted without the appropriate ethics form will be returned unassessed.**

If ANY of the items in the Declaration are not ticked AND / OR if you have answered YES to ANY of the questions in Section IV, you will need to describe more fully in Section V of the form below how you plan to deal with the ethical issues raised by your research. **This does**

I, the undersigned, confirm that (please tick box as appropriate):

|     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                     |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1.  | I have read and understood the information about the project, as provided in the Information Sheet dated _____.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 2.  | I have been given the opportunity to ask questions about the project and my participation.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 3.  | I voluntarily agree to participate in the project.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 4.  | I understand I can withdraw at any time without giving reasons and that I will not be penalised for withdrawing nor will I be questioned on why I have withdrawn.                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 5.  | The procedures regarding confidentiality have been clearly explained (e.g. use of names, pseudonyms, anonymisation of data, etc.) to me.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 6.  | If applicable, separate terms of consent for interviews, audio, video or other forms of data collection have been explained and provided to me.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 7.  | The use of the data in research, publications, sharing and archiving has been explained to me.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 8.  | I understand that other researchers will have access to this data only if they agree to preserve the confidentiality of the data and if they agree to the terms I have specified in this form.                                                                                                                                                                                     | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 9.  | Select only <b>one</b> of the following: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I would like my name used and understand what I have said or written as part of this study will be used in reports, publications and other research outputs so that anything I have contributed to this project can be recognised.</li> <li>I do not want my name used in this project.</li> </ul> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
|     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 10. | I, along with the Researcher, agree to sign and date this informed consent form.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |

**Participant:**

Ly Gia Han